

LIFELONG LEARNING POLICY

Rationale

Higher education institutions' transactional and time-boundedness nature has been drastically impacted and debunked by highly unpredictable needs of the industries and societal uncertainties in general. This has refreshed universities back to the pedagogical principle that: *"Learning is a never-ending process"*. Thus, the relationship between students and the university is lifetime. However, research has revealed that there is a prevalent mismatch between what the industries require and what universities offer in its academic programs. Employers' demands of knowledge, skills, and attitudes from prospective employees drastically change thus pressuring universities not just to respond to the demands but also to the distinct needs of individual student particularly in their lifelong learning development. This implies that universities should take care of students from enrollment to professional development.

Scope

This policy covers all academic and non-academic units within the university, including:

- Undergraduate and graduate students
- Teaching and support staff
- Alumni and returning learners
- Relevant external stakeholders engaged in continuing education, upskilling, or reskilling or talent stacking initiatives

The policy likewise covers all formal, non-formal, and informal learning initiatives such as:

- Academic degree and certificate programs
- Full online, blended and hybrid learning
- Professional and technical training
- Community extension professional education
- Data-driven learning and development programs
- Micro-credential courses or certificates
- Interdisciplinary courses or programs

Guiding Principles

The policy is anchored in the following principles:

- **Democratization:** The policy is inspired by inclusivity and accessibility which means all individuals, regardless of socio-economic background shall have equitable access.
- **Adaptability and Innovation:** Learning routes should respond to diverse learner needs such as micro-credentials, online modules, and hybrid or flexible delivery modes.
- **Significance:** Programs or courses should be future-proof - aligned with current and future societal and industry needs.

- **Learner-Centeredness:** Curriculum and instructional designs should be tailored to the needs and interests of learners, leading to the development of self-regulated learning and metacognitive competencies.
- **Linkages and Collaboration:** The university shall collaborate with government agencies or organizations, relevant industries, local government or communities, and international partners.
- **Quality Assurance:** All lifelong learning initiatives shall be subjected to regular quality assessment, evaluation, and continuous quality improvement.

Compliance

All colleges, academic programs, and support offices are required to:

- Integrate lifelong learning principles and programs/courses into curricular and co-curricular programs.
- Develop self-instructional modules and professional development programs that align with this policy.
- Ensure cognizance to national and international frameworks on lifelong learning and quality standards (AQRF, PQF, AUN-QA, PQA, UNESCO, ABET, Seoul Accord).
- Submit reports to the Chief Academic Officer or Academic Affairs office, detailing the objectives, performance indicators and results.

Non-compliance with the policy may result in the delay of approvals of budget or internationalization efforts and possible sanctions.

Implementation and Review

The implementation of this policy shall be led by the **Laboratory of Life Committee (LoL)** under the supervision of the Chief Academic Officer. The committee shall:

- Craft implementation and evaluation guidelines and deliverables
- Coordinate training and capacity-building for teachers and support staff
- Monitor and evaluate the effectiveness of lifelong learning initiatives

This policy shall be subjected to regular review (3 years) or as the need arises. This is done to ensure relevance and alignment with internal and external requirements and demands. The result of the review will be communicated to the management and other relevant stakeholders.

Signed:

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